

Getting a Free Gemini API Key

About 2 minutes. You need a Google account. No credit card required. This key powers the characters in Promptulus.

Steps

1. Go to **aistudio.google.com/apikey** and sign in with your Google account.
2. Accept the Google AI Studio terms if asked.
3. If this is your first visit, AI Studio creates a project and an API key for you. Otherwise, click **Create API Key** and choose a project **with no billing account attached**.
4. Click the copy icon next to the key. It is a long string that starts with `AIza`.
5. Open Promptulus at **ai4ra.github.io/promptulus** and paste the key into the box on the landing page.

What "free" means

- **No cost.** A project with no billing account stays on the free tier. If you link billing, usage is charged at paid rates.
- **Rate limits.** Free keys allow a limited number of requests per minute and per day. If replies stop, wait a minute and try again.
- **Your inputs may be reviewed.** On the free tier, Google may use what you type to improve its products, and human reviewers may read it. **Do not enter sensitive, confidential, or personal information.**
- **Eligibility.** Google's terms require you to be 18 or older. Some regions, including the EU, UK, and Switzerland, have extra restrictions.

Keep your key safe

- Treat it like a password: don't post it, email it widely, or commit it to code repositories.
- If a key leaks, delete it in AI Studio and create a new one.
- The app keeps your key only in your browser tab. It is never stored and is cleared when you close the tab.

Details change over time. Current rules: ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/pricing, .../rate-limits, and .../terms. Checked October 2026.

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